Anniket

Senior Game AI & Systems Engineer | Gameplay Architecture Specialist

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Dear Ken Levine and the Ghost Story Games Team,

I am writing to express my profound excitement in applying for the **Principal Game AI Engineer** role on *Judas* at Ghost Story Games. As an engineer who has delivered **50+ interactive game and VR titles** across complex state machines, procedural systems, and emergent gameplay loops, Ken Levine's seminal GDC talk on "*Narrative Legos*" has long been one of my guiding architectural philosophies: building systemic, modular AI agents whose desires, perceptions, and interpersonal relationships generate organic, personal stories rather than scripted sequences.

In bringing *Judas* to a shipping-ready polish, the core challenge is transforming systemic unpredictability into robust, believable enemy behaviors that react with theatrical precision to player agency. Here is how my technical background and production experience align with Ghost Story's ambitions:

- **Game AI Architecture & Perception Systems:** Deep experience architecting Behavior Trees, Utility AI, and sensory perception pipelines. Skilled at designing layered combat decision loops, squad coordination protocols, dynamic aggro/threat evaluation, and spatial tactical queries (EQS/navigation meshes) that produce intelligent, unscripted enemy combatants.
- **Animation & Motion Integration:** Hands-on experience integrating modern animation techniques with runtime AI states: root motion synchronization, distance matching, motion warping, blend spaces, and procedural inverse kinematics. I ensure enemies look physically grounded and reactive while executing agile combat maneuvers without snapping or visual pop.
- **Unreal Engine & C++ Systems Hardening:** Extensive foundation in modern C++ and engine architecture. Proficient in debugging edge-case race conditions, profiling CPU execution paths, and hardening dynamic gameplay systems into deterministic, crash-free, shipping-quality releases.
- **Player-Centric Design Sensibility:** Beyond pure algorithms, I view AI primarily through the lens of player emotion and readability. AI must telegraph its intent, fail gracefully, and celebrate the player's cleverness—crucial for delivering the signature immersive storytelling that defines Ghost Story.
- **Autonomous Asynchronous Execution:** Proven track record collaborating remotely with international directors and cross-disciplinary teams, maintaining clean documentation, rigorous Git version control, and rapid iteration cadence.

To help shape the living, reactive adversaries of *Judas* alongside the creators of *BioShock* and *System Shock 2* would be an incredible milestone. I am eager to bring my engineering rigor and passion for emergent narrative

systems to your team.

Thank you for your time, vision, and consideration.

Sincerely,
Anniket
Senior Game AI & Systems Engineer
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